Sway

Company Overview Sway is an American material science startup that creates seaweed-based packaging to replace thin-film plastics. They focus on manufacturing clear bags, retail polybags, and food wrappers—the types of single-use plastics that are the hardest to recycle and the most likely to pollute nature.

ESG Focus: Regenerative Seaweed Films (Flexible Plastic Alternatives)



Why (The Problem) Thin-film plastics (like shopping bags and product wrappers) make up a huge portion of ocean pollution. They cannot be easily recycled because they tangle up recycling machines, so almost all of them end up in landfills or the ocean, where they choke wildlife and break down into microplastics.

How (The Solution) Sway uses seaweed as their primary raw material. Seaweed is a regenerative resource that grows incredibly fast without needing arable land, freshwater, or chemical fertilizers. Sway mixes seaweed extracts with other plant-based materials to create a strong, flexible, and naturally colorful film that can be used in traditional plastic packaging machinery.

What (The Outcome) The result is a high-performance packaging film that is 100% bio-based and truly "home-compostable." Instead of lasting for 500 years like a plastic bag, a Sway bag will completely decompose in a backyard compost bin within 4 to 6 weeks, turning into nutrient-rich soil.

Impact: Sway won the Tom Ford Plastic Innovation Prize for their breakthrough technology. By scaling up production, they aim to replace millions of single-use plastic bags annually while simultaneously supporting coastal communities and seaweed farmers around the world.